PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

April 20, 2026
Community Engagement Session: School Rightsizing - Virtual

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Portland Public Schools Board of Education Community Engagement Session was held virtually and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Board Members Present: Christy Splitt, Michelle DePass, Patte Sullivan, Rashelle Chase-Miller, Virginia La Forte, Stephanie Engelsman, Eddie Wang, Student Representative Ian Ritorto

Staff: Kimberlee Armstrong - Superintendent; Jon Franco - Senior Chief of Operations; Margaret Calvert - Assistant Superintendent; Nichole Watson - Senior Director of Family and Community Engagement; Sharon Toncray - Chief Legal Counsel; Kristina Howard - Senior Chief of Academics.

Call to Order and Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 6:06 pm.

Welcome + Grounding + Framing
Superintendent Armstrong opened the meeting. Board Members, including the Student Representative, introduced themselves and shared what they hoped to learn. Context was provided for the need to consolidate schools.

Interactive Polling
Participants were asked to provide information about who they were and what their experiences may be with past school changes.

Small + Whole Group Discussion
Assistant Superintendent Margaret Calvert explained the factors driving decisions — enrollment trends, facility utilization, boundaries, program placement, grade configurations, and possible consolidations — emphasizing multiple factors would be considered together, not just enrollment alone.

Neighborhood Gallery Walk
Participants were provided an opportunity to engage with a shared interactive map showing school locations, capacity, enrollment, and utilization rates.

Ranking the Factors
Participants were invited to identify their top 2–3 priorities from the six factors named in the Student Assignment to Neighborhood Schools Policy.

Public Comment:

Sam Bevington Logan-future creston students-walkability. New housing projects coming up.
Lisa Jackson- Member of the Southeast Guiding Coalition advocated for a transparent process.
Sarah Horn -Creston parent requested to see the data on the savings from consolidation schools and what will be reinvested.
Nicholas Verbot-Middle School teacher would like to know what families are willing to give up, and stated that predictability will be helpful to have parents make informed decisions.

Joann Godrey-retired PPS teacher advocated for focus options schools and does not support standardized tests or curriculum.
Jen Marrinan-Teacher from Jason Lee advocated to hear from Title 1 students and count Pre-K students in enrollment.

Closing
Each board member gave closing reflections and additional engagement sessions were announced.

Adjournment

The session ended at 7:40 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
Senior Board Manager
Portland Public Schools